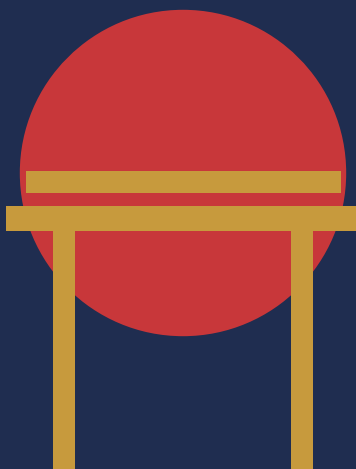




JAPAN

TRAVEL CHEAT-SHEET

Essential phrases & etiquette for first-time travelers

- 01 Greetings, Basics & Numbers
- 02 Navigation & Getting Around
- 03 Shopping & Dining
- 04 Emergencies, Etiquette & Wifi
- 05 Top Vital Kanji

Fold, save, or print — keep it in your pocket

Greetings, Basics & Numbers

QUICK PRONUNCIATION RULES

Vowels are short & flat (a="ah", e="eh"). Double letters get a tiny pause (kippu). Keep pitch flat — don't stress syllables like in English.

GREETINGS & BASICS

Ohayou gozaimasu

おはようございます

Good morning

Konnichiwa

こんにちは

Hello / good afternoon

Konbanwa

こんばんは

Good evening

Arigatou gozaimasu

ありがとうございます

Thank you (polite)

Sumimasen

すみません

Excuse me / sorry

Onegaishimasu

お願いします

Please (asking for something)

Douzo

どうぞ

Go ahead / here you go

Hai

はい

Yes

Iie

いいえ

No

Daijoubu desu

大丈夫です

It's okay / I'm fine

NUMBERS

1

一

ichi

2

二

ni

3

三

san

4

四

yon / shi

5

五

go

6

六

roku

7

七

nana / shichi

8

八

hachi

9

九

kyuu / ku

10

十

juu

100

百

hyaku

1,000

千

sen

10,000

万

man

Navigation & Getting Around

SURVIVAL & NAVIGATION

Eki wa doko desu ka?

駅はどこですか？

Where is the station?

Eigo ga hanasemasu ka?

英語が話せますか？

Do you speak English?

Chotto matte kudasai

ちょっと待ってください

Please wait a moment

[Basho] made onegaishimasu

[場所] までお願いします

To [location], please (taxi)

TRANSIT ESSENTIALS

[Basho] iki wa nanbansen desu ka?

[場所] 行きは何番線ですか？

Which platform for [place]?

Kono densha wa [basho] ni tomarimasu ka?

この電車は [場所] に止まりますか？

Does this train stop at [place]?

Kono kaado o chaaji dekimasu ka?

このカードをチャージできますか？

Can I recharge this IC card?

Futsuu / Kaisoku / Tokkyuu

普通・快速・特急

Local / Rapid / Limited Express

GOOD TO KNOW

Boarding the wrong train type is the #1 first-timer mistake — Tokkyuu (limited express) often needs a paid seat reservation. Check the platform sign before boarding.

Shopping & Dining

KONBINI & SHOPPING

Kore o kudasai

これをください

Please give me this

Ikura desu ka? / Okaikei onegaishimasu

いくらですか? / お会計お願いします

How much? / Check, please

YOU MAY HEAR

Oshiharai wa dou nasaimasu ka?

お支払いはどうなさいますか?

How would you like to pay?

Kurejitto kaado wa dekimasu ka?

クレジットカードはできますか?

Can I pay by credit card?

Genkin de haraemasu ka?

現金で支払えますか?

Can I pay by cash?

Atatamete kudasai

温めてください

Please warm it up

Shichaku dekimasu ka?

試着できますか?

Can I try this on?

YOU MAY HEAR

Fukuro wa go-riyou desu ka?

袋はご利用ですか?

Would you like a bag?

Hai, onegaishimasu

はい、お願いします

Yes, please

lie, daijoubu desu

いいえ、大丈夫です

No, thank you

RESTAURANT

YOU MAY HEAR

Nan-meī sama desu ka?

何名様ですか?

How many in your group?

Hitori desu

一人です

Just one / table for one

Futari desu

二人です

Two of us / table for two

[Shokuhin] wa haitte imasen ka? (arerugii)

[食品] は入っていませんか? (アレルギー)

Does this contain [food]? (allergy)

Bejitarian desu / Butaniku nashi de

ベジタリアンです / 豚肉なしで

I'm vegetarian / no pork please

Sumimasen!

すみません!

Excuse me! (calling a server)

Emergencies, Etiquette & Wifi

EMERGENCY ESSENTIALS

110

POLICE

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AMBULANCE / FIRE

Tasukete!

助けて！

Help!

Isha ga hitsuyou desu

医者が必要です

I need a doctor

[Pasupooto / Saifu] o nakushimashita

[パスポート／財布] をなくしました

I lost my [passport / wallet]

ETIQUETTE IN 30 SECONDS

- No tipping — ever, anywhere.
- Remove shoes at the genkan (entryway step) indoors.
- Keep phone calls off trains; keep voices low.
- Cash is still king — carry yen even if cards are common.

HANDY LOCAL TIPS

- Coin lockers at stations hold luggage for a few hours or all day (¥300–700, cash or IC card).
- Break large bills at a konbini — handy before buying or topping up an IC card.
- Buy an IC card (Suica/PASMO) at any station machine, then add cash whenever it runs low.
- Public trash cans are rare — use the small bin by a konbini door, or carry it until you find one.

WIFI

Wifi wa arimasu ka?

Wifi ありますか？

Is there wifi?

TIP

Free public wifi is patchy — most travelers rent a pocket wifi or grab an airport eSIM before arrival.

Top Vital Kanji

入

Entrance

出

Exit

押

Push

引

Pull

上

Up

下

Down

男

Male

女

Female

駅

Station

円

Yen

禁

Prohibited

お手洗い

Restroom

ONSEN (HOT SPRING) BASICS

Hairu mae ni karada o aratte kudasai

入る前に体を洗ってください

Wash your body before entering

Tatuu wa daijoubu desu ka?

タトゥーは大丈夫ですか？

Are tattoos okay? (many onsen restrict)

REMEMBER

Bathe naked (swimsuits aren't used), and keep small towels out of the water. Tattoo-covering stickers are sold at some front desks.